

HOUSE LEDGER

How to open and use the app — Desktop & Android

House Ledger is an offline-first expense tracker for the house-building project. It runs entirely in your browser — there is nothing to install on a desktop, and on a phone it can be added to your home screen like a regular app. All of your data lives on your own device; nothing is sent anywhere.

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1. Before you start

House Ledger lives at one web address (URL). This guide uses a placeholder — replace it with your app's real address once it's deployed:

```
https://your-house-ledger.vercel.app
```

Where to get the real URL: whoever set up the app deploys it once (for example, to Vercel) and that step produces this address. Ask them for it, or check the project's README for the exact deploy steps if you're setting it up yourself. Once you have it, every step below is the same — just swap in your real address.

You do not need to install any software to use House Ledger on a desktop computer — it opens in your normal web browser (Chrome, Edge, or Safari). On Android, you'll install it as an app icon in a couple of taps, covered in Section 3.

2. Opening the app on your desktop

Works in Chrome, Edge, or Safari on Windows, Mac, or Linux.

- 1 Open your web browser.
- 2 Type the app's address into the address bar: **https://your-house-ledger.vercel.app** and press Enter.
- 3 Wait a few seconds for the page to load fully the first time — this also quietly saves a copy of the app on your computer so it can open instantly (and even offline) the next time.
- 4 You'll see the dark navy **HOUSE LEDGER** header and the Dashboard. You're in.

Optional: pin it as its own desktop app

Chrome and Edge can install House Ledger as a standalone app window (no address bar, its own icon), the same way it works on a phone:

- 1 Look at the right side of the address bar for a small install icon (a monitor with a downward arrow, or a + in a box).
- 2 Click it, then click **Install** in the popup.
- 3 House Ledger now opens from your Desktop, Start Menu, or Dock like any other application.

If you don't see the install icon, you can skip this — a regular browser tab works exactly the same way and keeps the same data.

3. Installing the app on your Android phone

This must be done in the **Chrome** app (not Samsung Internet or another browser) for the install prompt to appear correctly.

- 1** Open the **Chrome** app on your phone.
- 2** Tap the address bar at the top and type: **https://your-house-ledger.vercel.app**, then tap Go.
- 3** Wait for the page to fully load. Keep the screen open for a few seconds — this lets the app save itself for offline use.
- 4** Tap the menu button — **three vertical dots** in the top-right corner.
- 5** Tap **Add to Home screen** (on some phones this appears as an **Install app** banner near the address bar instead — tap that if you see it).
- 6** Confirm by tapping **Add** or **Install** on the popup.
- 7** Go to your phone's home screen. You'll see a new **House Ledger** icon (dark navy square with a stacked-coins symbol).
- 8** Tap the icon to open it. The app fills the whole screen — no browser address bar or tabs — exactly like a normal installed app.

From now on, always open the app from this home screen icon, not by typing the address into Chrome again — the icon is faster and works offline immediately.

Everything in the app works with no internet connection at all — adding entries, viewing the dashboard, adding bills, and backing up or restoring your data. You can safely use it in airplane mode.

4. Dashboard — your running total

This is the screen you land on when you open the app. It updates instantly every time you add, edit, or delete anything.

- The large bold number at the top is the **total spent** across every entry in the ledger.
- Below it, a bar for each of the 11 categories (Sharik, Nitin, Wood, Electrical, Govt Fee/Chalan, MDA/Mutation, Gift, Site Prep, Legal, Utility Bill, Misc) shows how much has gone to each.
- At the bottom, a list shows how much each family member has personally paid so far.

There's nothing to tap here to change data — this screen is read-only. Use the tabs at the bottom of the screen to add or edit entries.

5. + Entry — adding an expense

Tap the **+ Entry** tab at the bottom to log a new payment. Fill in the fields:

- 1 Date** — defaults to today; tap it to pick a different date.
- 2 Category** — choose the closest fit from the dropdown (e.g. "Sharik" for a payment to that contractor).
- 3 Description** — a short label, e.g. "Payment to Sharik". Required.
- 4 Sub-vendor / detail** — optional; a shop or sub-contractor name, e.g. "Kisan Treders".
- 5 Amount (■)** — the rupee amount. Required, and must be more than zero.
- 6 Payment mode** — Cash, one of the GPay accounts, Cheque, etc.
- 7 Paid by** — which family member made the payment.
- 8 Notes** — optional, anything else worth remembering.
- 9** Tap the crimson **Save entry** button.

If the description is empty or the amount is zero, the app shows an error message under the form and won't save until it's fixed — this prevents accidental blank or ■0 entries from polluting the ledger.

After saving, a small "✓ Entry saved" confirmation appears and the form clears, ready for the next entry.

6. Ledger — searching and managing entries

Tap the **Ledger** tab to see every entry ever recorded, newest first.

- **Search box** — type any word from the description, vendor, notes, payer, or payment mode to filter the list instantly.
- **Category dropdown** (next to search) — narrow the list to one category at a time.
- Each row shows the description, date, a small category badge, payment mode, who paid, and the amount.
- The total shown just above the list reflects only the entries currently visible (i.e. after your search/filter) — handy for adding up a specific category or vendor.

Deleting an entry

- 1 Tap the small **delete** link under an entry's amount.
- 2 Two buttons appear: **Delete** (confirms) and **Keep** (cancels). This two-tap confirmation prevents accidental deletion.
- 3 Tap **Delete** to remove it permanently, or **Keep** to back out.

Exporting to CSV

Tap **Backup CSV** above the list to download a spreadsheet file of exactly what's currently visible (respecting your search/filter). Useful for opening in Excel or sharing a specific category's spend.

7. BOQ — tracking itemized bills

BOQ ("Bill of Quantities") is for recording the individual line items on a shop or contractor invoice — separate from the simple one-line ledger entries in Section 5.

Adding a bill

- 1 Tap the **BOQ** tab, then tap **+ Add bill**.
- 2 Fill in **Vendor**, **Invoice #**, **Date**, and **Category**.
- 3 Enter the **Invoice total** — the grand total printed on the physical bill.
- 4 For each line on the bill, add a row: description, quantity, unit, rate, and amount. Tap **+ add row** for more lines (e.g. separate rows for SGST, CGST, or Rounding, exactly as printed).
- 5 Check the summary line at the bottom: it shows whether your line items add up to the invoice total. If they match, it turns green with a checkmark. If not, it turns red and shows the difference.
- 6 If there's a genuine mismatch you can't resolve, tick the acknowledgement checkbox that appears to save anyway.

- 7 Only tick **"Also create a ledger entry for this bill's total"** if this payment *isn't* already recorded in the Ledger — otherwise you'll double-count it.
- 8 Tap **Save bill**.

Reconciliation table

Below the Add Bill button, a table compares, per category, how much you've itemized in BOQ bills versus how much is recorded in the Ledger — a quick sanity check on whether your itemized bills line up with your actual payments.

Viewing and deleting bills

- 1 Under **Bills on record**, tap any bill to expand it and see every line item.
- 2 Tap **delete this bill**, then confirm, to remove the whole bill (all its line items) at once.

8. Data — backup, restore & reset

Tap the **Data** tab. This is your safety net — since everything lives only on this device, exporting a backup is the only way to protect against a lost or reset phone.

Exporting a backup

- 1 Tap **Export full backup (.json)**.
- 2 A file downloads to your device containing every ledger entry and BOQ item.
- 3 Move or copy that file somewhere safe — email it to yourself, save it to Google Drive, etc. Do this regularly.

The "Last backup" date at the top of this screen turns red if it's been more than 7 days, or if you've never backed up — treat that as a reminder, not just decoration.

Restoring from a backup

- 1 Tap **Import / restore from backup...** and choose a previously exported **.json** file.
- 2 The app shows how many entries and BOQ items are in that file and warns that this will **replace** everything currently on the device.
- 3 Confirm to proceed, or cancel to back out without changing anything.

Other options on this screen

- **Entries CSV / BOQ CSV** — export either table separately as a spreadsheet.
- **Reset to seed data** — wipes everything and restores the original starting data. Requires confirming twice, since it can't be undone unless you've exported a backup first. Mainly useful while testing.

9. Good habits & troubleshooting

- **Back up weekly at minimum.** The app keeps data only on the one device you're using — there's no cloud sync.
- **Always launch from the home-screen icon** on your phone, not by retyping the address in Chrome.
- **Airplane mode is fine.** Every screen — Dashboard, + Entry, Ledger, BOQ, and Data — works with no signal at all.
- **Android back button** takes you back to the Dashboard from any tab, and closes a bill's review screen, without ever closing the app itself.

- **If the app looks out of date after an update** was made to it, close it fully and reopen from the home screen icon — it fetches the newest version automatically the next time it's online.
- **If install doesn't appear** on Android, make sure you're using the Chrome app (not another browser), and that the page has fully finished loading before opening the three-dot menu.